

Nikita Menshutin

Senior Backend Developer · Security Engineer

Varna, Bulgaria | Open to remote roles worldwide

info@nikita.global | t.me/nikita_global | linkedin.com/in/nikitaglobal |
github.com/nikitaGlobal

Professional Summary

- 15+ years of experience as a Senior Backend Developer specializing in PHP, Laravel, Symfony, and high-performance WordPress.
- Core engineer at WPChef on Limit Login Attempts Security — a WordPress login security plugin with 1M+ active installations (brute-force protection, ACL, 2FA/MFA, firewall).
- Ships WordPress security products at scale: Limit Login Attempts Security, Disable AI for Security, and additional unpublished security plugins under NDA.
- Led the full migration of a legacy SaaS application (TestRail) from PHP 7 to PHP 8; WordCamp Sofia 2024 speaker and WordCamp Sofia 2026 volunteer.

Key Skills

PHP | Laravel | Symfony | WordPress | WordPress Security | Brute-force /
ACL / MFA | Plugin Architecture | JavaScript | TypeScript | Python |
ReactJS | MySQL | Redis | Docker | CI/CD | REST API | Playwright e2e | OpenAI
API | Git

Professional Experience

WPChef — Senior Backend / Security Engineer

Nov 2025 - Present

Product company behind Limit Login Attempts Security — trusted by 1M+ WordPress sites for login security.

- Own the PHP backend for Limit Login Attempts Security: login protection, lockouts, ACL (safelist/denylist), MFA/2FA flows, and WooCommerce / XML-RPC / multisite edge cases.
- Evolve cloud-backed security: Micro Cloud onboarding, usage/quota surfacing, and cloud vs local ACL failover — keeping free and premium paths production-ready under attack load.
- Refactor the monolith core into a service-oriented PHP architecture; harden compatibility (CSP nonces, WordPress 7 admin UI, reverse-proxy IP origin).
- Ship Disable AI for Security — a zero-config kill-switch for WordPress 7 AI connectors (core filter + admin lockdown).
- Shipping additional unpublished WordPress security plugins under NDA.
- Drive release hygiene: changelog-driven iterations, support-facing fixes, and translation-ready strings across security UX.
- Build and maintain Playwright e2e coverage for critical login, logout, MFA, and WooCommerce flows — cutting regression risk before wordpress.org releases.

Stack: PHP, WordPress APIs, MySQL, cloud security APIs, WooCommerce hooks, MFA, ACL, Playwright, CI-friendly plugin packaging

edited.com — Senior Backend Developer / Senior WordPress Developer

Sep 2023 - Nov 2025 | UK/Bulgaria

One of the largest B2B fashion intelligence portals.

- Architected and delivered custom WordPress plugins with HubSpot, GTM, and Pendo integrations, enabling the marketing team to launch automated campaigns and track user funnels.
- Implemented a full end-to-end test suite with Playwright, reducing manual QA from a multi-day effort to a few hours per release and virtually eliminating critical pre-launch bugs.
- Replaced default site search with an AI-powered SearchWP solution, boosting search result click-through and improving content discovery for users.
- Established the company's first CI/CD pipeline for WordPress projects, automating deployments and standardizing code quality across the team.
- Integrated the OpenAI API to build a content summarization feature, providing a key differentiator for the platform's premium offering.

Dev Tactics — Senior Backend Developer

Feb 2022 - Sep 2023 | Poland/Germany/USA

- Led the full migration of TestRail, a legacy Test Management Tool, from PHP 7 to PHP 8, including code audit, refactoring, compatibility validation, and rollout.
- Redesigned and implemented REST API v3 for APILayer, documenting it with OpenAPI (Swagger) to reduce onboarding friction for integration partners.
- Architected and delivered data-collection integrations for ZenScape across search, maps, and stock data sources within a microservices architecture (Laravel, Symfony, Flask).
- Refactored critical modules in legacy services, decreasing bug volume and simplifying onboarding for new developers.

New Statesman Media Group — Senior Backend Developer

Jun 2020 - Feb 2022 | UK/Bulgaria

Publisher of [newstatesman.com](https://www.newstatesman.com), one of the largest and oldest newspapers and media portals in the UK.

- Scaled and optimized high-traffic WordPress properties (LAMP stack), ensuring 99.9% uptime and fast load times for millions of monthly readers.
- Built a custom WordPress plugin for in-article polls with BigQuery integration for analytics and reporting.
- Created a content-targeting plugin (PHP/TypeScript) integrated with Permutive.io to support personalized ad campaigns.
- Mentored 2 junior engineers through code reviews and pair programming, supporting their growth to Mid-level roles within 18 months.

Founder & Lead Developer — nikita.global (Freelance)

Mar 2009 - 2020

Delivered end-to-end solutions for international clients (including Upwork and Toptal), with a focus on custom WordPress development, e-commerce integrations, and legacy modernization.

- **High-load media project:** Architected and scaled a WordPress platform for a rap magazine with traffic peaks around 1M monthly visitors.

- **E-commerce integrations:** Developed custom WooCommerce payment and warehouse integrations, including marketplace-related workflows (AliExpress, eBay).
- **Mobile product backend:** Built backend services and REST APIs (Laravel, PHP) for a React Native baby-monitoring app, supporting features that led to a 4.5-star app-store rating.

Education

- **MBA in Marketing** — Cardiff Metropolitan University of Wales, UK (2012)
- **French Language Course** — Institut International de Langues & Affaires, Rambouillet, France

Certifications

- **PHP Developer, Professional** — Otus (2023)
- **Advanced PHP** — Udemy (2020)

Community

- Core engineer at WPChef for [Limit Login Attempts Security](#) (1M+ active installations)
- [Disable AI for Security](#) — WordPress 7 AI kill-switch
- WordCamp Sofia 2026 volunteer; WordCamp Sofia 2024 speaker; WordPress plugin developer and translator — [WordPress profile](#)
- Creator of ViK Bot, a Telegram bot that warns about planned water outages in Bulgarian cities (since 2019)

Latest CV:

- [Web version](#)
- [PDF version](#)